



Nepalese soldiers carrying children to a helicopter to help their parents board during evacuation operations on Thursday in the aftermath of a mammoth flash flood.

HUGE WAVES SPED
THROUGH VALLEYS,
TRAPPING VICTIMS

A RIVER ROSE 650 FEET

Many Foreigners Among
1,800 Missing or Dead
in Nepal and Tibet

This article is by Binod Ghimire, Anupreet Das, Leo Sands and Michael Levenson.

KATHMANDU, Nepal — It was already too late when the call came. Rajan Khatri, 41, a police officer, was working at his station in a mountain village in northern Nepal when a friend rang on Wednesday morning to warn that a flash flood was thundering downriver in his direction. As soon as he hung up, giant waves slammed into the station.

“I cannot explain how big the waves were,” Mr. Khatri said from a hospital bed in Nepal’s capital, Kathmandu, on Thursday. “They engulfed several meters-high buildings in a fraction of seconds. It wasn’t just water. It was a combination of boulders, sand and thick sludge.”

The onslaught flung Mr. Khatri out of the building, and he lost consciousness and suffered chest injuries. Two of his colleagues survived, but four were missing on Thursday.

They were among the more than 1,400 people missing in the devastating deluge of rock, ice, trees, mud and water that blasted through river valleys on the border between Nepal and Tibet, washing away bridges, smashing homes, schools and hydropower plants, and swallowing people who tried to run away.

On Thursday, emergency workers climbed across steep Himalayan valleys and used helicopters to ferry shocked survivors to safety as they carried out a sprawling search for anyone who had managed to escape the flood.

Nepali officials said at least 389 people had been killed, while the authorities in China, where far less information was being released, reported three deaths in Tibet.

The death toll was expected to rise.

In Nepal, more than 900 people, including about 500 foreign visitors, were unaccounted for, the country’s disaster management agency said. The missing foreigners included at least 288 from India, as well as travelers from the United States, Australia, Britain, Canada and Malaysia.

In Tibet, at least 558 people

Combative Treasury Chief Confronts His Limits

By ALAN RAPPEPORT
WASHINGTON — When auditioning to be President Trump’s Treasury secretary, Scott Bessent accused Democrats of constructing a centrally planned economy. He argued that their interventions in markets were politically motivated and said the sitting Treasury secretary, Janet L. Yellen, was purposely changing how government bonds were being sold to stimulate the economy before the 2024 election.

Bessent Faces a Test of
Credibility as He Tries
to Tame Markets

“History teaches us that prioritizing free enterprise and limiting government’s role in the economy are key to raising living standards,” Mr. Bessent said at a Manhattan Institute conference. Two years later, as Treasury

secretary, Mr. Bessent is seeking his own interventions into the markets and the economy in ways that conflict with his stated philosophy.

Since entering the White House, the second Trump administration has taken equity stakes in more than two dozen companies and subsidized the U.S. critical minerals industry.

A former skeptic of tariffs, Mr. Bessent last week called the taxes that the government collected

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Meta, After Binding Its Hands,
Wants Its Rivals to Do Likewise

By MIKE ISAAC
SAN FRANCISCO — The up to \$17.1 billion that Meta agreed on Wednesday to pay to 47 states, the District of Columbia and some U.S. territories to settle a three-year-old lawsuit probably won’t sting that much for Mark Zuckerberg, Meta’s chief executive.

The details of the settlement, however, could leave a mark. Meta also agreed to rein in children’s access to its marquee products like Instagram and Facebook, create daily time limits, increase parental controls and cut off access during school hours.

That could permanently alter how Meta interacts with its youngest users, the next generation to scroll and click on its various apps, and make it hard for the company to uphold its claim to be the world’s dominant social media company.

Mr. Zuckerberg has a contingency plan: Level the playing field, so that children can’t just

Worrying Competitors’
Apps Will Get Edge
With Children

switch to the app of a competitor. If he has to play by new rules, he wants companies like YouTube and TikTok to do the same. Meta built a financial incentive into its deal with the state attorneys general, designed to rope in the other companies.

Here’s how it would work: The base line of Meta’s monetary settlement is \$12 billion. The company has also agreed to a two-hour daily time limit for children. Meta will reduce that to one hour if YouTube and TikTok also agree to a one-hour limit. And if the other companies also pay \$5 billion to the states, Meta will throw in the rest of the \$5 billion or so it has promised.

It is not clear what sort of mechanism

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YAYOI KUSAMA, 1929-2026



Her art caused a stir in New York and Europe in the 1960s. But she had a second act. Page A18.

Virtually 24/7, What a Way She Made a Living

By KIM BHASIN
“Well, can you believe — 40 years here?” Dolly Parton said last year after she emerged from a giant pink cake to celebrate the anniversary of Dollywood, her popular theme park. “Hooray for Dollywood, right?”

Dollywood, in Pigeon Forge, Tenn., has served as a beacon for all things Dolly for decades, the

Parton Empire Shaped
Celebrity Branding

centerpiece of a business empire that preceded most of its celebrity peers. Yet beyond the roller coasters, bumper cars and country music museum, Ms. Parton’s legacy — she died on Tuesday, at 80 — in-

cludes setting the foundations for what a modern celebrity brand could become.

Over her six-decade singing and entertainment career, Ms. Parton built a range of enterprises that spanned retail, hospitality, food, publishing and consumer goods, long before the age of influencers and the products they now sell. A musical about her life is set

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Absolved of a Crime, but Feeling Far From Free

By SHAILA DEWAN
LORAIN, Ohio — In 1990, Nancy Smith, a divorced mother of four, took a job as a bus driver in Lorain, Ohio, a working-class city on the underbelly of Lake Erie. Each time a child got on her bus, she marked half of an X on the roster. When the child got off, she marked the other half. The children gave her hugs and holiday gifts.

One day in 1993, Ms. Smith was pulled off the route. A mother had come forward with a startling story she had heard from her 4-year-old daughter: Ms. Smith and a bus aide named Joseph had taken the child not to preschool, but to a basement where Joseph and the children got undressed, played “doctor,” and worse.

The lead detective on the case had a difficult time corroborating the story. A medical examination found no signs of abuse. The bus had not been late, mileage records showed no discrepancies and there had been no suspicious ab-

sences. The children who rode the bus told the detective that nothing unusual had happened. There was no aide named Joseph.

But word spread. “They started putting the stuff on TV and the newspapers,” Ms. Smith recalled. “I was just like: Oh my God. What the heck?”



Nancy Smith was exonerated in a child sexual abuse case.

Soon, more 4- and 5-year-olds were brought to the police to repeat jumbled stories of sexual abuse involving sticks, needles and cups of urine. Asked to point out where they had been taken, they identified at least six houses. They mentioned a man named Joseph, but described him variously as white, Black, Latino or even Black with white spots.

Ms. Smith cooperated with investigators, expecting that the truth would win out. Instead, one morning she woke to find a front-page headline trumpeting the arrest of a man named Joseph Allen, who was not a bus aide but had a prior conviction for child molesting. “That was the very first time I ever seen that man,” she told me.

A few hours later, she looked out the front window and saw an unmarked police car drive by. Ms. Smith, who was living with her mother at the time, recalled saying, “Oh my God, Mom, they’re going to come and arrest me.” Next, she saw a patrol car. Ms. Smith,

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Going Out in Style

Elaborate coffins seen at celebratory funeral services in Ghana are on display at a New Mexico museum. PAGE C1

All Lined Up for Harry

Fans arrived early to see Harry Styles kick off a 30-night residency at Madison Square Garden this week. PAGE C10



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Russia’s Bleak Report on War

The C.I.A. chief’s meeting in Moscow with a Russian intelligence leader was aimed at pushing the Kremlin to pursue a peace deal with Ukraine. PAGE A8

New Name for a Great Lake

President Trump signed an executive order to change the name of Lake Ontario to Lake America. PAGE A8

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The ‘Butcher of Bosnia’

Ratko Mladic was convicted in the massacre of some 8,000 Muslims at Srebrenica in 1995. PAGE A21

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Hawk Fire a Warning for Reno

The Sierra Nevada region is a hot spot for wildfires, and some see the latest blaze as a push for communities to guard against catastrophe. PAGE A9

New White House Counsel

Will Scharf has proved his loyalty to President Trump as a member of his private legal team. Now he steps into a tricky assignment. PAGE A15

Firings After LaGuardia Crash

Two controllers who left their posts are among a dozen nationwide the F.A.A. has taken steps to fire as part of a time-card inquiry, people said. PAGE A17

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Jets Head Coach Reflects

Aaron Glenn learned tough lessons in his first year. He does not intend to make the same mistakes. PAGE B7

Shear Brilliance or Cruel Cut?

The soccer star Erling Haaland has cut his locks. A look at top athletes’ form after they opt for a drastic ‘do. PAGE B11



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E.V. Sales at New Heights

A slower 2026 global market for electric vehicles was predicted, until a Gulf oil shock sped up a shift. PAGE B1

Pushing Back at Trump

The Fed governor Lisa D. Cook countered the president’s allegations that she committed mortgage fraud. PAGE B1

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Jessica Grose

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